



Cognitive Psychology (COGPSY)

Module 2: Human Learning

What is Learning

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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What Is Learning?

Learning is a relatively permanent change in behaviour, knowledge, skills, or attitudes that results from experience. Relatively permanent means the change lasts beyond the moment. From experience means it is not only biological growth.

Learning versus Maturation

Maturation is change caused by natural growth and aging. A child becoming tall enough to reach a shelf is maturation, not learning. Changes from injury or disease are also not counted as learning in the usual sense. Learning needs experience as the cause.

Knowledge, Skills, and Attitudes

Learning is not only memorising facts. Knowledge is understanding ideas. Skills are being able to do something, such as writing a clear summary. Attitudes are more stable views or readiness to act. University work trains all three.

Reflect: Give one example of knowledge, one skill, and one attitude you have learned since starting university.

Closing

The next lesson covers conditions that support learning and superstitious behaviour.